



Spanish 1

COURSE 0708340 • GRADE 9 • HIGH-SCHOOL CREDIT • TWO SEMESTERS • OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE — FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. It was drawn from one section of the course as taught this year, and each teacher leans into their own strengths and passions — so scholars may see some variation in activities, projects, and pacing from section to section, and between the live school and On-Demand. The structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

What this course is: A high-school-credit introduction to Spanish taught through daily practice and rich culture immersion. Semester 1 builds the foundation — pronunciation and the alphabet, the body and classroom, greetings, family, numbers, and the essential verbs *ser*, *estar*, and *tener* — anchored in the culture of **Mexico** (Día de los Muertos, geography, Velázquez's art). Semester 2 tackles the core of the language — systematic present-tense conjugation from regular *-ar/-er/-ir* verbs through the full set of irregulars and stem-changers — applied to weather, the home, food, music, and city life, with the cultural lens moving to **Spain** and Puerto Rico.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE (by quarter)

- Q1 ¡Bienvenidos! Commands & TPR, the body & classroom (incl. labeling them in VR), alphabet & pronunciation, greetings; Mexican geography • **alphabet test, Maleta de México & comic-strip assessments**
- Q2 Family & Día de los Muertos; numbers to 100; *gustar*; *ser/estar/tener*; describing people; adjective agreement • **Las Meninas art project, famous-person project, family tree, ser/estar/tener test**
- Q3 Present tense: *ir* and regular *-ar/-er/-ir* verbs; weather; the house, furniture & chores; Puerto Rico • **El Pronóstico forecast project, oral assessment: La casa**
- Q4 Irregulars & stem-changers; Spanish music (La Oreja de Van Gogh), Bécquer's poetry in VR, food & shopping; Spain's regions • **"Jueves" project, cooking project, VR Geography of Spain, final year-end test**

PROJECTS & SPEAKING

- Creative, culture-tied projects each quarter: **Culture Bag, comic strip, Las Meninas, famous person of Mexico, family tree, weather-forecast video, cooking/shopping project, Geography of Spain in VR.**
- Oral proficiency is built in: assessments regularly include a **recorded speaking submission.**
- Grace notes: the final test can replace a weaker score; New Year's grapes extra credit; "sing for my birthday to drop a test."

A TYPICAL WEEK

- **Duolingo** — daily app practice; a 5-day streak earns full credit (screenshot submitted weekly)
- **Quizlet** vocabulary sets for the week's theme
- **Conjuguemos** verb drills — the Semester-2 backbone
- **Participation self-score** — students honestly rate their own week
- Most weeks: a **VR or Nearpod activity**; units close with an assessment or project

TIME COMMITMENT

≈4 hours per week (250 minutes — about 50 min/day, M–F)

Duolingo ≈1 hr (spread daily) • Quizlet/Conjuguemos practice ≈1½ hr • lessons, culture & VR ≈1 hr • projects/assessments ≈½ hr

Per-part split is an estimate; the 250-minute weekly total comes from the school's course plan. Project weeks may run longer.

WHAT STUDENTS NEED

- A computer with access to Canvas
- Free accounts on **Duolingo, Quizlet, and Conjuguemos** (set up in week 1); Nearpod activities are linked in-course
- A way to record speaking videos; VR headset for VR activities (live-school students use VR daily)

On-Demand (asynchronous): This overview describes the self-paced experience the course is designed for — students work through lessons on their own schedule with an Optima teacher available for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school: Students enrolled in the live virtual school take this same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.